

SCAFFOLD SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

8-10 MINUTES

Verify the tag, access, platforms and guardrails before use.

OBJECTIVE

Review fall, falling-object, unsafe-access, incomplete-platform, overloading and unauthorised-alteration hazards, and verify the scaffold tag, inspection date and physical condition before use.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- A scaffold is a complete system consisting of platforms, top rails, mid-rails, toe boards, ladders, trapdoors, braces and ties. A single missing component can increase the risk of a fall or structural failure.
- Scaffolds must only be erected, altered and dismantled by authorised scaffold personnel. Users must not remove or reposition platforms, rails, ladders or structural components for convenience.
- Even when the tag is acceptable, the user must complete a visual inspection before every use. Untagged or red-tagged scaffolds must not be used, and yellow-tag conditions must be understood before access.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A team used a green-tagged scaffold to reach a pipe connection. During the task, a mid-rail was removed to pass material through the platform.
- The rail was not replaced before the shift changed. The next team began work without noticing the missing component, and a worker lost balance near the open edge.
- The event could have been prevented by prohibiting unauthorised alterations, reporting the defect immediately, closing the scaffold and arranging reinspection by the authorised scaffold team.

REMEMBER

A valid tag is not enough. Do not use a scaffold with missing, loose, damaged or altered components; report the condition immediately.

SCAFFOLD SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, control measures and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- Untagged, red-tagged or overdue scaffold inspection.
- Missing top rails, mid-rails or toe boards.
- Incomplete, loose or damaged working platforms.
- Open trapdoors and access openings.
- Unsafe ladders or climbing outside the scaffold.
- Unauthorised removal or alteration of components.
- Overloading and unsafe material storage.
- Tools and materials falling to lower levels.

CONTROL MEASURES

- Verify the scaffold tag and inspection date.
- Complete a visual inspection before every use.
- Check top rails, mid-rails and toe boards.
- Confirm platforms are complete, secured and undamaged.
- Keep trapdoors closed when not in use.
- Use only the designated safe access route.
- Never alter scaffold components without authorisation.
- Do not exceed the permitted load capacity.
- Secure tools and barricade the area below.
- Stop use and report defects immediately.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Team, before accessing the scaffold today, we will check the tag, inspection date, access, platforms, guardrails and trapdoors. We will not use the scaffold if the tag is missing, red or if any component is incomplete. No one may remove rails, decks or structural parts. Any defect must be reported and the scaffold kept out of use until checked by the authorised scaffold team.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- What colour is the scaffold tag and is the inspection date valid?
- Are the platforms complete, secured and undamaged?
- Are guardrails and toe boards complete?
- Are trapdoors closed when not in use?
- Is a safe access ladder available?
- Who must be contacted if a defect is identified?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Tag acceptable | ☐ Inspection date valid |
| ☐ Platforms complete | ☐ Guardrails complete |
| ☐ Toe boards fitted | ☐ Trapdoors functional |
| ☐ Access safe | ☐ No unauthorised changes |
| ☐ Lower area protected | ☐ Load capacity suitable |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

SCAFFOLD SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
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Supervisor notes / additional site instructions